ASSESSMENT STRATEGY PLAN

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Pre-engagement planning document for automated security assessment

TARGET SYSTEM	127.0.0.1
PREPARED BY	SCOPE Platform
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Disclaimer

1 Purpose & Objectives

This document defines the strategy, scope, and approach for the planned security assessment. It is intended to align stakeholders on objectives, methodology, and expected outcomes before the assessment begins.

Objectives

- Identify security misconfigurations and weaknesses in the target system.
- Evaluate compliance against the organisational security baseline.
- Provide actionable remediation guidance for all identified findings.
- Establish a current security posture snapshot for tracking improvement over time.

2 Assessment Scope

In Scope

- Operating system configuration and kernel parameters
- Installed packages and service versions
- Running services and open network ports
- User accounts, groups, sudo rules, and SSH configuration
- File system permissions and SUID/SGID binaries
- Firewall and network filtering rules
- Logging and audit configuration
- Authentication and PAM configuration

Out of Scope

No explicit exclusions defined. All default SCOPE modules are in scope unless otherwise constrained.

Constraints & Assumptions

- Assessment will be conducted without root privileges unless explicitly granted.
- No active exploitation or offensive techniques will be used.
- All data collection is read-only and non-destructive.
- System availability will not be impacted during assessment.

3 Methodology

SCOPE performs a structured, non-intrusive audit of local system state using OS-native interfaces and configuration file inspection. No network scanning or active exploitation is performed.

Assessment Phases

PHASE 1 Reconnaissance & Data Collection

Collect system metadata, installed packages, running services, and configuration files using SCOPE's data collection modules.

PHASE 2 Configuration Analysis

Evaluate collected data against security baseline rules, known misconfiguration patterns, and hardening benchmarks.

PHASE 3 Finding Classification & Triage

Classify all findings by severity, assign remediation priority, and group by category for reporting.

PHASE 4 Reporting & Handover

Generate the assessment report, review findings with stakeholders, and deliver remediation guidance.

4 Risk Acceptance Criteria

SEVERITY	REQUIRED RESPONSE	SLA
CRITICAL	Immediate escalation — owner approval required before acceptance	24 hours
HIGH	Owner approval before acceptance	72 hours
MEDIUM	Log, assign, and schedule remediation	14 days
LOW	Log and review in next cycle	90 days
INFO	Informational — no action required	N/A

5 Roles & Responsibilities

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITIES
Assessment Lead	Configure and execute the assessment; review all findings; deliver the final report.
System Owner	Grant access; review and accept/reject findings; approve remediation actions.
Security Team	Validate critical findings; advise on remediation; sign off on risk acceptance decisions.
Operations	Implement remediation steps; confirm resolution; retest as required.

6 Expected Deliverables

- **Preliminary Assessment Report (PDF)** — Full findings report with severity breakdown and remediation guidance.
- **Raw Findings Export** — Machine-readable JSON export of all findings.
- **Executive Summary** — One-page summary for non-technical stakeholders.
- **Remediation Tracker** — Prioritised list of remediation tasks with ownership and SLA assignments.

Disclaimer

This Assessment Strategy Plan is a pre-engagement document generated by SCOPE to outline the planned approach for a security assessment. It does not constitute a legal authorisation to conduct testing. Prior written approval from the system owner must be obtained before any assessment is initiated. This document is for internal planning purposes only and should be treated as confidential.

Generated by **SCOPE** — Security Configuration Observation and Protection Engine — 2026-03-22